

Open business and regulatory questions

MFI Manager — decisions required before the blocked modules can be built

Twelve questions, carrying thirty-one entries in the decision register. Each blocks a module that moves real money, and none can be answered from the supplied documentation. Until an answer arrives the system refuses rather than guesses — every “current behaviour” below is the conservative option, chosen so that no borrower’s balance moves for a reason nobody decided.

Answering a question does not by itself change anything. Each answer becomes a change that is reviewed and tested like any other.

Questions for the institution

Policy decisions belonging to the microfinance service provider. None can be inferred from the supplied documentation, and each governs money owed by or to a borrower.

Shares

SHARES-01...06 · \$13.5

QUESTION

What is the par value of a share? What rules govern subscription? Are shares transferable between members? What is the dividend declaration process? Are shares withdrawable?

WHY IT MATTERS

Shares are members’ capital. Treating a withdrawable share as permanent capital overstates capital adequacy; declaring a dividend under the wrong rule distributes money that was not earned.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

The shares module entirely. The permissions `share.read` and `share.manage` exist and enforce nothing.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Nothing is built — no table, no screen, no arithmetic. The MSP2 shares line reports nil, which is correct: the institution holds no shares in this system. There is no partial implementation to mislead anyone.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

All five answers, plus the Bank of Tanzania’s expected treatment on MSP2-01.

Group lending

GROUP-01...04 · \$13.6

QUESTION

Is liability fully joint, or several? Does a group loan disburse to the group or to members individually? What are the group guarantee rules? How is a default handled?

WHY IT MATTERS

Liability decides who owes what after a default, which decides classification and provisioning, which decides the whole of MSP2-03 for those loans.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Groups entirely — membership, joint-liability arithmetic, group disbursement.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

No group tables and no group code. A loan to a member of a group is an ordinary loan to that borrower, which is accurate under several liability and would need revisiting under joint liability. BOT’s loan-type taxonomy already carries group headings, so such a loan can be reported; what does not exist is any group entity.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

The liability model first. The other three answers follow from it.

Loan fees

QUESTION

What qualifies as a fee? When is it charged? Is it refundable? How does it interact with settlement and repayment?

WHY IT MATTERS

A fee is money the borrower owes that is neither interest nor principal, so it changes both the outstanding balance and the income statement.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Fee accrual. Nothing charges a fee.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

The payment allocator has a fee bucket in a fixed position — second, after penalties and before interest — and it allocates nil. The position is deliberate and must not move: introducing the bucket later at a different point in the order would retrospectively change how every payment already recorded would have been split.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

A definition of a fee and a charging trigger. The bucket is already in place.

Early settlement

SETTLE-01...04 · §13.8

QUESTION

Does a settlement discount apply? What happens to future interest, to accrued penalties, and to fees? Which date governs the settlement figure?

WHY IT MATTERS

Future-interest treatment alone can change a settlement figure by the entire remaining interest of the loan.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Any “settle this loan today” operation.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

No settlement endpoint exists. A borrower paying off early records ordinary repayments, which reduce the balance exactly as they otherwise would. Nothing is waived and nothing is discounted, because no rule says anything should be.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

All five answers. A partial answer produces a partial settlement figure, which is worse than none.

Restructuring

RESTRUCT-01...05 · §13.8

QUESTION

What makes a loan eligible? Who approves it? What happens to accrued interest, to penalties, to fees, and to outstanding principal? What becomes of the old schedule, and how is the new one generated? What is the accounting treatment? What is the reporting treatment?

WHY IT MATTERS

A restructure rewrites a live loan's schedule. Done without a rule, it rewrites history.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Any restructure operation.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Nothing exists — no partial workflow that could half-apply and leave a loan inconsistent. The loan status machine has no restructured state and no transition to one.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

All nine answers, plus the Bank of Tanzania's view on whether a restructured loan resets its classification.

Write-offs and recoveries

MFI MRECOVERNO1WRITEOFF01

QUESTION

Is a recovery on a written-off loan a repayment, separate income, or a reinstatement of the loan? And separately: who may write a loan off, at what point, and what happens to accrued interest, penalties and any provision already raised?

WHY IT MATTERS

It decides which line of MSP2-02 the money appears on, and whether the loan returns to the book.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Recording a recovery — and writing a loan off at all. There is no write-off operation in the application; the status is reachable only by a direct database change. The two are one decision.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

A payment against a written-off loan is refused, with a message naming the status. Written-off is terminal in the status machine — there is no transition out of it. A recovery therefore cannot be quietly recorded as an ordinary repayment, which would put money on a return under a heading nobody chose.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

The accounting treatment, then a dedicated operation. Not a relaxation of the current refusal. Note that BOT's own MSP2-02 taxonomy already carries both a bad-debts-written-off line (Sno 14) and an income-from-recovery line (Sno 21), which suggests income rather than repayment — but says nothing about whether the loan is reinstated or the borrower's balance moves.

Cross-institution staff identity

IDENTITY-01

QUESTION

May one person hold staff accounts at two different institutions?

WHY IT MATTERS

Email identifies a user at login, before any institution is known, so the address must be unique across the whole system. An address therefore belongs to exactly one institution, for all time.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing today. It is a limit somebody will eventually meet.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Inviting an address that already has an account anywhere is refused. Within the institution the refusal is specific and useful. Across institutions it is a generic conflict that names no table, no institution and no person.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

If the answer is yes: a membership table separating identity from institution. That is a schema and login change, not a small one.

Questions for the Bank of Tanzania

Interpretation questions about the MSP2 return. Each is held as an explicit parameter and the convention actually used is printed on the compiled form, so whichever answer arrives, what was filed remains auditable.

Rate annualisation

BOT-11.2

QUESTION

Are MSP2-04 rates read as simple (monthly × 12) or effective $((1 + \text{monthly})^{12} - 1)$?

WHY IT MATTERS

At 5% a month the two differ by nearly twenty percentage points — 60% against 79.59%. The wrong convention misstates every rate on the form.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing. Both conventions are implemented.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

An explicit query parameter, simple by default, and the convention used is printed on the compiled return. The choice is visible on the filed form rather than buried in the compiler.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

One answer. The parameter stays either way — it is what makes the answer auditable.

Age-band reference date

QUESTION

As at which date is a borrower's age measured for MSP2-10's demographic bands?

WHY IT MATTERS

A borrower who turns 36 during a quarter falls in a different band depending on the date chosen.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing. The date is a required argument.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Nothing defaults it, so no caller can accidentally measure age as at today when the return covers a quarter that ended months ago.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

The reference date. The parameter already exists to receive it.

Housing loans under 91 days overdue

BOT-11.5

QUESTION

BOT's housing microfinance provisioning schedule begins at 91 days and defines no band below it. How should a housing loan 0–90 days overdue be classified?

WHY IT MATTERS

Every other loan type has a band covering its first ninety days. Housing does not, so there is no rule to apply.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Classification of housing loans in their first ninety days of arrears.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Such a loan is NOT classified, and is never folded into Current. It is surfaced on its own row so the gap reaches an operator. Quietly calling it performing would understate provisions and file a wrong MSP2-03.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

A ruling. Until then the gap stays visible, which is the point.

Fiscal year for the year-to-date column

BOT-11.8 · BOT-11.8B

QUESTION

Does MSP2-02's year-to-date column mean the calendar year or the institution's own fiscal year? And must a fiscal year begin on a quarter boundary?

WHY IT MATTERS

The second half of this question is not academic. A fiscal year starting on a quarter boundary keeps every year-to-date window at twelve months or fewer. A start month that does not — December, say — makes one quarter straddle the boundary and produces a THIRTEEN-month window: Q4 2026 would run from 1 December 2025 to 31 December 2026.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing. Both are expressible.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Entries are dated rather than bucketed by quarter, so the same rows aggregate both ways. The fiscal year start is a required parameter, never defaulted, and the window actually used is reported on the form as "year to date from". The thirteen-month case is left exactly as it is and pinned by test, because choosing a rule for non-aligned fiscal years would be inventing an answer.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

One answer on the year, plus a note on whether a fiscal year must begin on a quarter boundary.

Audit retention period

AUDIT-01

QUESTION

How long must an institution retain its audit trail?

WHY IT MATTERS

Implementing deletion is a one-way door. Records removed on a schedule this system invented cannot be recovered for an inspection that asks for them.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing. Retention is simply not implemented.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Nothing is ever deleted. There is no purge job, no archival and no retention setting. The audit table has no update or delete policy for any role, so entries cannot be amended or removed even by the application.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

The retention period. Note that keeping everything is the safe default and is the current behaviour.

Prepared from docs/03-STATUS.md, which remains the authoritative list. Nothing in this document is a proposed answer. Where the system must do something while a question is open it refuses, or records the fact and leaves it visible — because on a system that moves real money, a guess does not announce itself.